

Most “marketing” is advertising with extra steps.

Define the words. Tap a desire that already exists. Read every action as a signal.

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5+ years in agencies. Lots of “marketing.” Almost no scoreboard.

Campaigns shipped. Decks approved. Reach celebrated. CAC unknown. LTV ignored.

The work looked like marketing because it was busy. [Busy is not a system.](#)

These three words get used as if they mean the same thing. They do not.

01 Brand treated as logos and colours

02 Advertising sold as “the marketing”

03 Impressions treated as results

That mix is why so much spend produces theatre, not customers.

04 / DEFINE THE WORDS

Marketing is every piece of communication a business has with its market.

Prospects and customers. The ad, the site, the email, the invoice, the founder reply, the packaging. If the business is speaking, that is marketing. It is not a department. It is not ads.

MKT

Advertising is one kind of that communication. It is not the whole of it.

A brand is the association someone has with something.

It lives in their head, not in your logo file. You do not ship a brand in a deck. People form it from every piece of communication — and from whether the thing you sold held up.

BRAND

Branding is only the word for trying to influence that association.

Advertising brings someone's attention to something specific.

That is the job. A paid ad, a billboard, a launch post, a cold email with one object: look at this. It is marketing whose purpose is attention, not the relationship after.

Measured first with impressions – how many times was that specific thing put in front of someone?

ADS

Impressions start the scoreboard. They do not prove anyone cared.

People buy to solve a problem or fulfill a desire.

That is almost the whole game. Marketing cannot create a new desire inside someone. It can only tap a desire they already have, and cause them to act.

If the desire is not there, more reach is just more noise.

The action they take is always an investment — even when no money moves.

A click, an email, a call, a purchase. Attention and time are currencies. You asked them to spend something.

PERCEIVED VALUE

(outcome × likelihood of achievement)

(effort & sacrifice × time delay)

Frequency of similar claims divides the left side and lowers perceived value. That is market sophistication – a story for another day.

Every action is a signal of resonance. The metrics are the strength of that signal.



CTR

> 1.5%

OPT-IN / CVR

> 2% ideally

OPT-IN → CUSTOMER

> 10%

LTV : CAC

> 3

Below the bar, the market is not answering. Do not scale the channel.

You do not have a tactics problem.

You have a first-principles problem.

- | | |
|----|--|
| 01 | Fuzzy buyer → message cannot convert |
| 02 | Unclear offer → traffic is expensive |
| 03 | Guessed CTR → creative gets blamed for volume |
| 04 | Unknown CAC → spend scales a leak |
| 05 | Memory follow-up → intent dies cold |
| 06 | Ignored LTV → acquisition is treated as the whole business |

Often the copy asks for an investment the value equation cannot support, or speaks to a desire that is not there. Agencies get hired to add fuel. Nobody checks if the bucket holds water.

Name the constraint. Then engineer the fix.

Diagnose which signal is weak. Fix only that. Warm demand first. Scale only once LTV:CAC is above 3 with margin.

FIRST PRINCIPLES × REVENUE SYSTEM × AI LEVERAGE = HIGH-ROI GROWTH

AI is leverage inside the chain. It cannot choose the right work.

12 / FREE DIAGNOSTIC / 30 MINUTES

Want the constraint named — and the metric that proves it?

Thirty minutes. The bottleneck, the scoreboard reading, the first system worth building — whether or not we ever work together.

BOOK THE FREE DIAGNOSTIC



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NO HYPE · NO TOOL LISTS · FIRST PRINCIPLES, THEN SYSTEMS